

Shah Jahan Quadrangle

شاہ جہاں کا صحن

1. Basic Facts

- Built by: Emperor Shah Jahan
- Built in: c. 1631-1645 CE
- Cost: Not documented
- Built for: A distinct residential and administrative quadrangle - not to be confused with the separate Shah Burj Quadrangle

2. Construction Details

- Contents: The Diwan-i-Khas (Hall of Special Audience, built 1645), the Khwabgah-i-Shahjahani (Shah Jahan's own sleeping chamber, sometimes called the "Choti Khwabgah" or 'small bedroom' to distinguish it from Jahangir's larger "Bari Khwabgah"), and the Shahi Hammam (royal bath, built 1633)
- Materials/technique: Marble and pietra dura work consistent with other Shah Jahan-era construction in the fort

3. Historical Background

- This quadrangle is frequently confused with the separate Shah Burj Quadrangle, since both were built under Shah Jahan and both lie in the fort's residential northern section. They are, however, documented as two distinct quadrangles: the Shah Burj Quadrangle contains the Sheesh Mahal, Naulakha Pavilion and Summer Palace, while the Shah Jahan Quadrangle contains the Diwan-i-Khas and Shah Jahan's own sleeping chamber.
- The Khilwat Khana (private chamber complex, including the Kala Burj and Lal Burj pavilions) is documented as sitting east of the Shah Burj Pavilion and west of the Shah Jahan Quadrangle - i.e., physically between the two similarly-named quadrangles, which is likely part of why the two are so often mixed up.

4. Interesting Facts / Trivia

- The near-identical names "Shah Burj Quadrangle" and "Shah Jahan Quadrangle" are one of the more genuinely confusing naming overlaps in the entire fort - even several published heritage websites and tourist guides use the two names inconsistently.

5. Scenario / Narrative Moment

Two quadrangles, one emperor, and a naming coincidence historians are still occasionally caught out by: step through the wrong archway expecting the Sheesh Mahal's mirrored ceiling, and you may instead find yourself in the far quieter halls where Shah Jahan actually held his most private audiences.

AI Heritage Revive — Lahore Fort landmark reference. Compiled from encyclopedic research report; figures marked "Not documented" are intentionally left blank rather than estimated.